STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-4520
SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 02/26/19	DATE REVISED **01/03/22**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
	APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES		
SUBJECT TRAFFIC AND CRIMINAL SOFTWARE (TRACS)	CROSS REFERENCE P-3600 TOWING PROCEDURES		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for the use of the electronic citation, warning, DOT 40 (State Crash Report), and other forms with the Traffic and Criminal Software (TraCS) program, utilized by the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office will utilize the TraCS software to issue uniform citations and complaints, written warnings, DOT 40 (State Crash Reports), Tow/Impound Forms, along with documenting non-enforcement contacts. TraCS may also be used for documenting field interviews (F.I.) and other forms available within the program.

III. Definitions:

A. **TraCS Administrator**: A Deputy of any rank, appointed by the Road Patrol Commander, who is provided administrator privileges within the TraCS program to facilitate the maintenance of users, data, and best practices. The TraCS administrator is responsible to bring issues regarding TraCS to the specific Deputy, his/her Supervisor, or a Road Patrol Commander.

IV. Procedure:

A. TraCS Implementation & Use

1. The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office will utilize the TraCS software to issue uniform citations and complaints, written warnings, DOT 40 (State Crash Reports), Tow/Impound Forms, along with documenting non-enforcement contacts. TraCS may also be used for documenting field interviews (F.I.) and other forms available within the program.

2. Deputies trained in TraCS and who are on the "live" version of TraCS are required to use TraCS when completing and submitting all DOT crash reports, driver exchanges, and DMV re-exam forms.

3. Deputies who have received training, are assigned to the "live" server, and assigned a patrol car equipped with TraCS are required to use TraCS to issue and submit all citations, warnings, violations, and non-enforcement contact forms. Citations can be either criminal or traffic related. Deputies will turn in the "Officer Copy" of citations that correspond with an incident/arrest report.

4. The TraCS Program is a secure program that will automatically number and track the issuance of citation numbers. Citations are securely accounted for and stored within the TraCS Program.

5. Deputies may add notes in the "Officer Notes" section of all citations to document special circumstances with the case. This note is only available to the Deputy and is similar to writing notes on the back of the Officer's Copy of hand-written paper citations.

6. Deputies on the "live" version of TraCS may elect to use a paper citation when extenuating circumstances exists. Some possible occasion may include:

a) When there is an officer safety issue and returning to the patrol car to complete a citation would jeopardize officer safety.

b) If the Deputy's MDC, TraCS software, or equipment is not working. In such a case, the Officer will notify a TraCS Administrator.

c) If the Deputy is not operating a patrol vehicle and/or does not have access to the TraCS software.

d) With permission of a Supervisor.

7. If a Deputy must issue a paper citation, as soon as possible, the Deputy will transfer the written citation information to TraCS using the "paper entry mode", scan the offender's signature, and enter the paper citation number in the appropriate field and note the reason for the issuance of paper citation in the Prosecutor Notes section.

a) Once the paper citation has been transferred to TraCS, the paper citation shall be destroyed and the Officer Copy of the TraCS citation will be submitted to Transcription.

8. Paper citations will be securely maintained and issued by the Records Unit. (See A-5400 Records Management).

9. The F.I. card form in TraCS may be used by Deputies for the submission of field interview data, however, this is optional. Handwritten F.I. cards will still be accepted.

10. Deputies issuing citations, warnings, and violations with TraCS do not need to complete additional Traffic Stop Data Cards or non-enforcement contact forms via TraCS. The required data is compiled automatically with TraCS for submission to the Nebraska Crime Commission.

a) If a self-initiated contact ends with a verbal warning or no-violation disposition, a non-enforcement contact form must be completed in TraCS by TraCS users for the compilation of the necessary information.

11. TraCS is to be used to complete Tow/Impound Forms in accordance with policy P-3600 (Towing Procedures).

a) Deputies shall complete the tow form through the "Tow Information" section and then validate the form.

b) Deputies shall print the "Tow Report" only. Deputies shall not print the "Tow Release".

c) After the Deputy signs the form and obtains the Tow Operator's signature, both shall be scanned in TraCS.

d) Deputies shall scroll to the bottom and press "Yes" for Reporting Officer Approval after scanning both signatures.

e) After completing this process, the form will be in "Transferred" status.

B. TraCS Mid-Month Audit

1. A TraCS Administrator will conduct a mid-month audit to ensure all forms are completed and successfully transmitted.

2. If forms are found incomplete, the TraCS Administrator will email the Deputy and carbon copy his/her immediate Supervisor(s) to inform him/her of the incomplete form.

C. Errors in TraCS Forms

1. If a Deputy issues a citation that contains an error or needs to be disregarded by the Sarpy County Attorney's Office, the Deputy shall adhere to the following protocol.

a) Email a TraCS Administrator with the following information:

(1) TraCS citation number containing the error

(2) Report Number

(3) Description of the error

(4) New citation number (if applicable)

b) The Deputy will not submit the Officer Copy of the erroneous citation to Transcription. If the citation was already submitted to Transcription prior to recognizing the error, the Deputy shall notify a TraCS Administrator.

c) The Deputy will keep printed copies of all citations involved in the incident for proper record

2. The TraCS Administrator will follow the established protocol with the County Attorney's Office to ensure the appropriate citation is filed.